The Lighthouse Keeper

On the edge of the cliff stood an old lighthouse, its white walls weathered by a century of salt wind and rain. Every evening, just before dusk, the keeper would climb the spiral staircase to light the great lamp at the top. He had done this for thirty years without missing a single night. The villagers below had long forgotten his name, but they knew him by the steady beam that swept across the dark water, guiding fishermen safely home. Some nights, when the storms were fierce, he wondered if anyone still saw the light at all. But he climbed the stairs anyway. That was the promise he had made to himself, and to the sea.